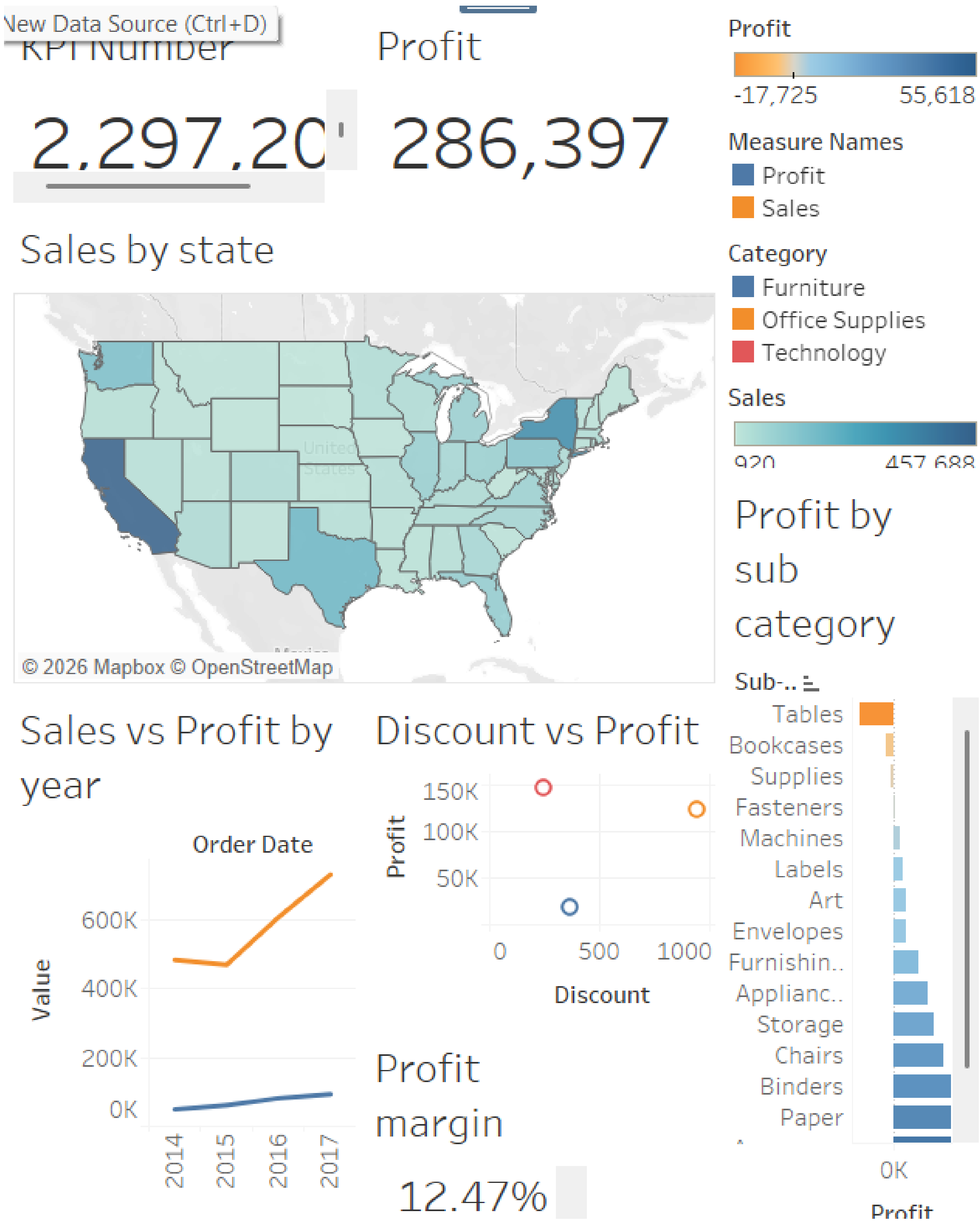
Superstore Sales

Data Visualization & Storytelling Report

Data Analyst Internship — Task 2 | Built in Tableau Public



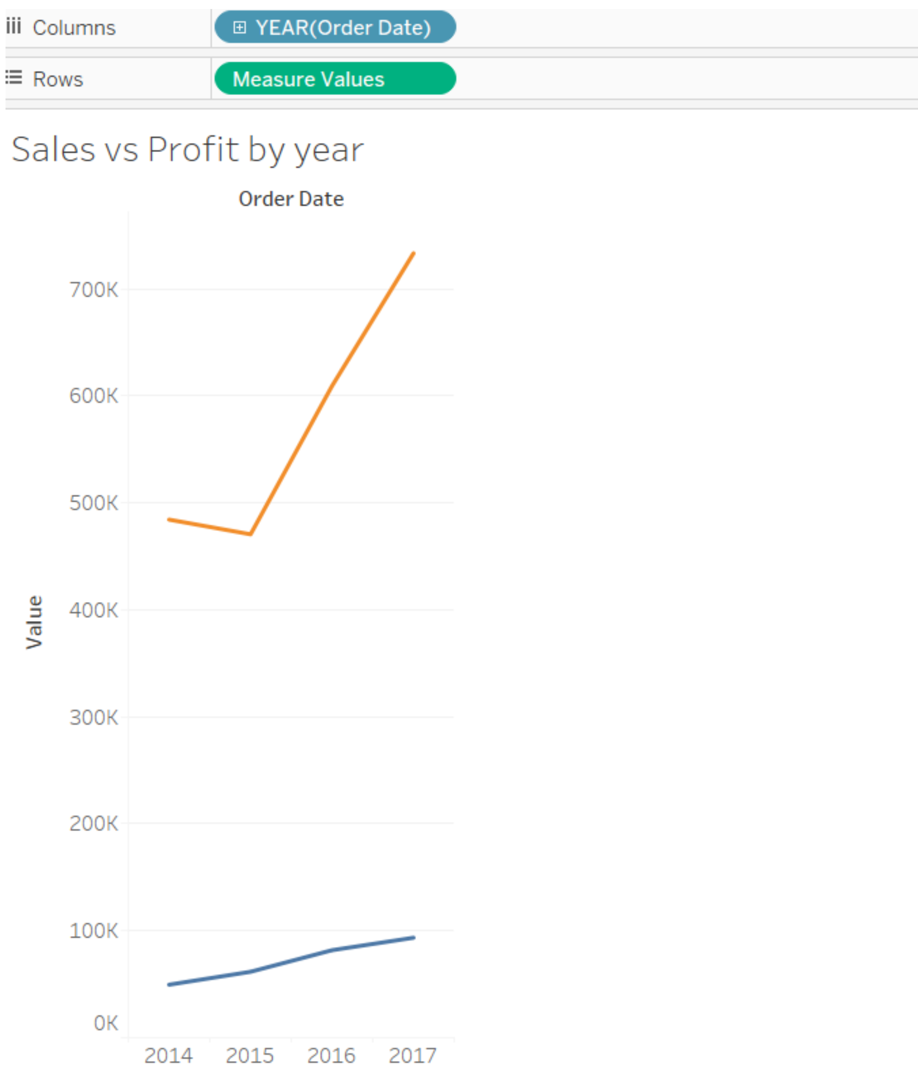
Executive Summary

Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin
$2.30M	$286K	12.47%

Across 9,994 orders placed between 2014 and 2017, the Superstore generated $2.30M in sales and $286K in profit, an overall margin of 12.47%. Sales and profit both grew every year, but profit growth has lagged behind sales growth, signaling gradual margin compression that is concentrated in a specific part of the business: the Furniture category, and Tables in particular.

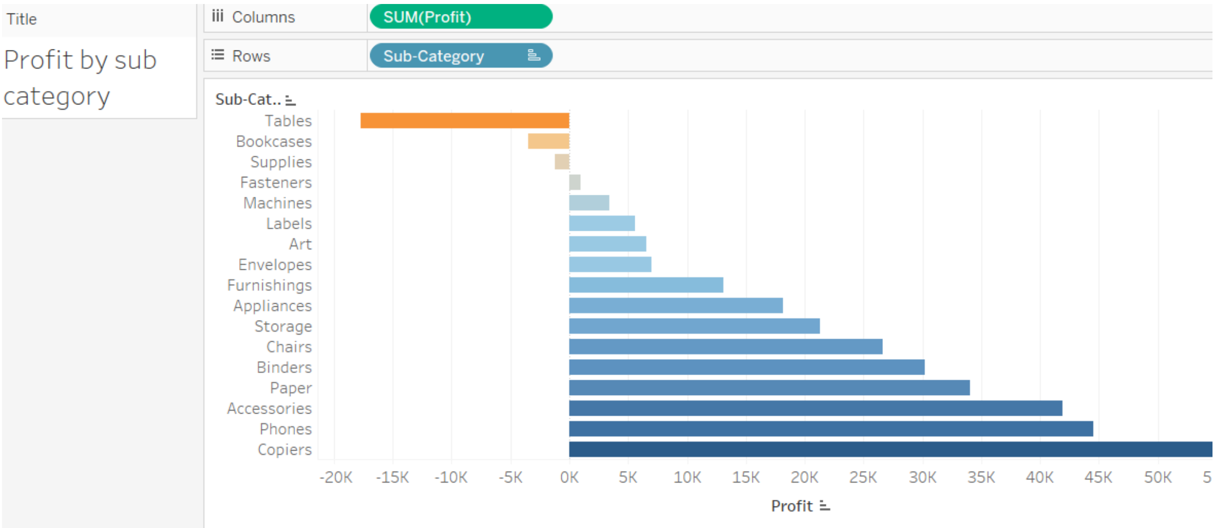
The Story in Four Charts

1. Sales Are Growing Faster Than Profit



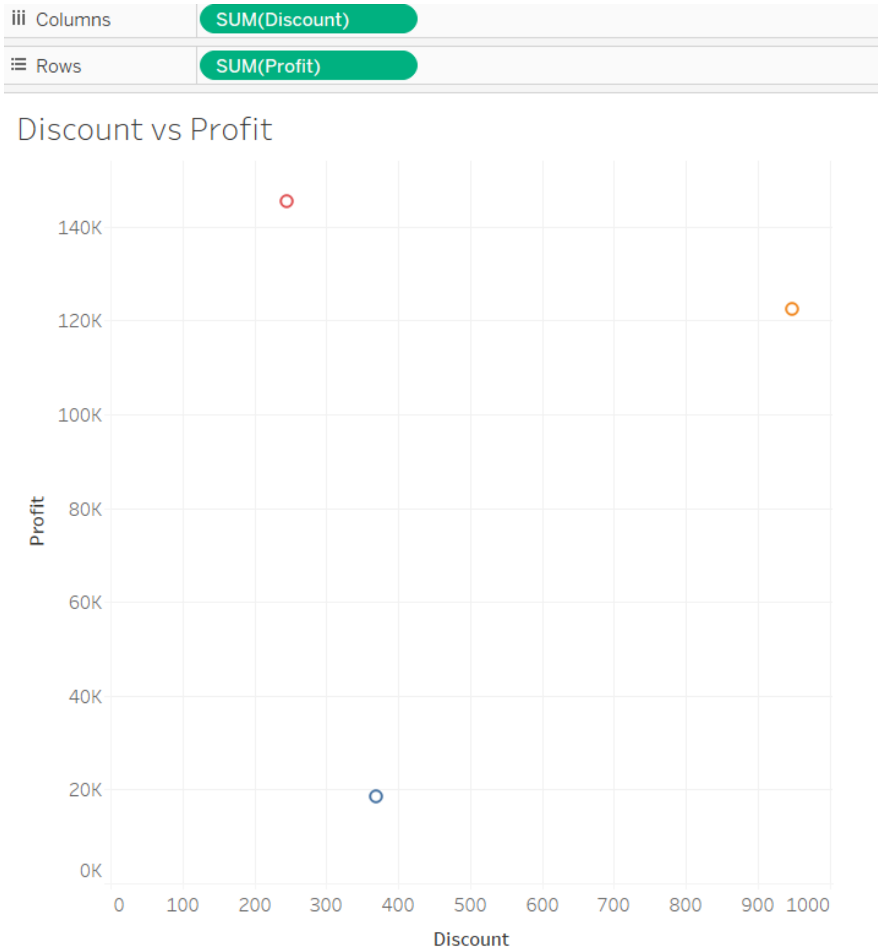
Sales (orange) climbed from roughly $484K in 2014 to $733K in 2017 — a 51% increase. Profit (blue) grew more slowly over the same period, from $50K to $93K. The widening gap between the two lines is the first sign that something is eating into margins as the business scales.

2. Tables and Bookcases Are Losing Money



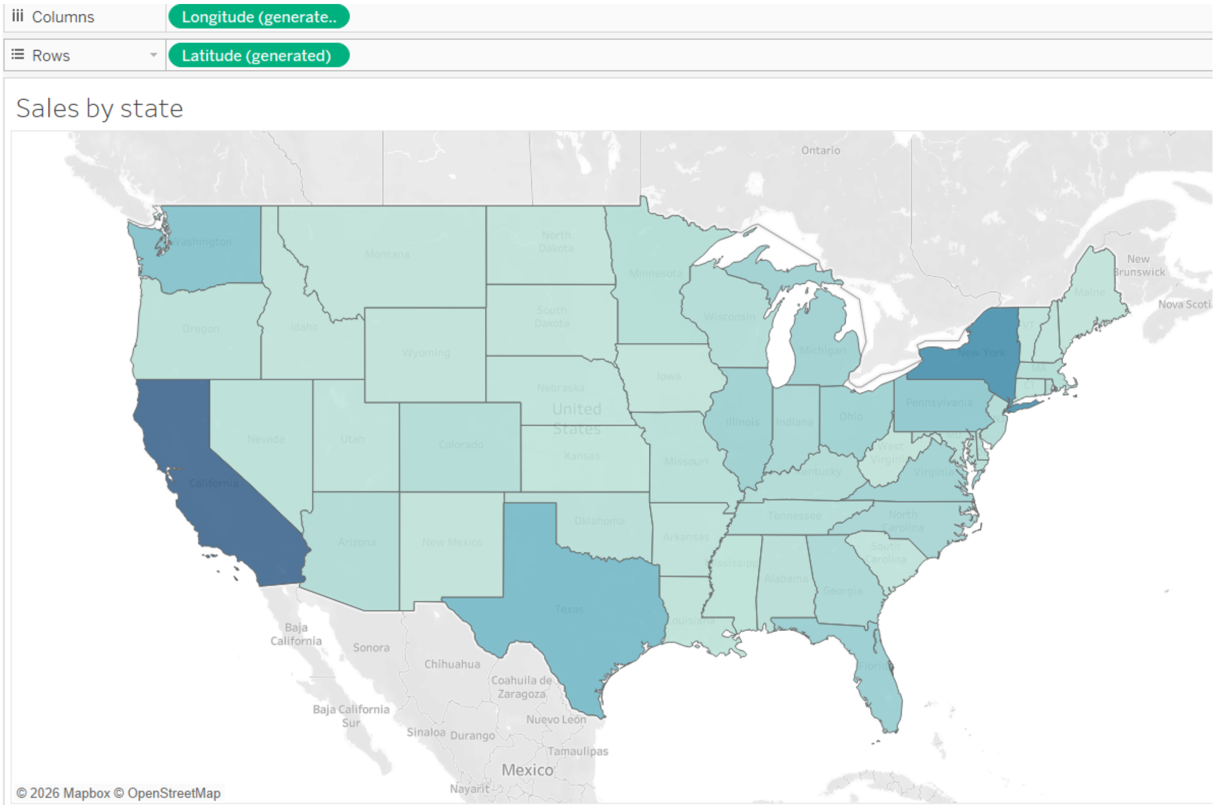
Sorting all 17 sub-categories by profit reveals that Tables (–$17.7K) and Bookcases (–$3.5K) are the only two operating at a net loss, despite Tables alone generating over $200K in sales. Copiers, Phones, and Accessories are by far the strongest profit drivers.

3. Heavy Discounting Is Linked to Lower Profit



Plotting discount against profit by category shows Technology (red) achieving the highest profit at a moderate discount level, while Furniture (orange) sits at the highest discount level for comparatively low profit. Across the full order-level data, discount and profit carry a negative correlation of –0.22 — the more a product is discounted, the more its profit tends to shrink.

4. West and East Regions Lead in Sales



California, Texas, and New York are the strongest individual states, anchoring the West and East regions as the top sales performers ($725K and $679K respectively), with Central trailing at $501K. This points to where customer demand — and marketing investment — is concentrated today.

Key Takeaway

Sales growth is healthy, but it is masking a profitability problem in Furniture. Tables and Bookcases are sold at a loss, largely driven by discounting that isn't being recovered through volume. Meanwhile, Technology delivers stronger margins at lower discount levels, and the West/East regions already outperform the rest of the business.

Recommendations

• Cap or restructure discounts on Tables and Bookcases — current discount levels are not being offset by sales volume.

• Investigate Furniture pricing and supplier costs separately from Technology, since similar sales volume yields roughly 8x less profit.

• Prioritize marketing and inventory investment in the West and East regions, which already deliver the strongest returns.

• Use Technology's discount-to-profit ratio as a benchmark when setting promotional discount limits for other categories.

Tool used: Tableau Public | Dataset: Sample Superstore (9,994 orders, 2014–2017)